

Level of Guests Satisfaction Towards Hospitality Services Using Gap Analysis

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Abstract

It is essential to give the highest satisfaction to gain guests' loyalty in the tourism and hospitality industry. Understanding their expectations and creating value in anticipating and managing their perceptions to respond to and satisfy their needs is one of the major considerations. Thus, this study was conducted to determine the level of guests' satisfaction with hotels' hospitality services using gap analysis. It utilized the descriptive-correlational to determine the mean difference between guests' perception and expectations anchored to Expectancy Disconfirmation Theory which explains how gap analysis is used in determining the level of guests' satisfaction. The study was conducted at Guiuan, Eastern Samar. Using convenient sampling, a total of 150 guests participated in the study. The results revealed that guests' perceptions and expectations have a negative service quality gap in the attributes of responsiveness, reliability, and assurance, while there is a positive gap for tangibility and empathy. Meanwhile, there is a significant difference between guests' perceptions and expectations. Therefore, the negative service quality gap and a substantial difference between expectation and perception indicate guests' dissatisfaction with the hospitality services. Thus, hotels must exceed guests' satisfaction on dimensions of reliability, responsiveness, and assurance. They have to invest in those aspects of the service quality attributes to cater to a better service to guests' merit to their needs and wants.

Keywords: Guest Satisfaction, Hospitality Services, Gap Analysis

Introduction

Guest perception and expectations have a relation to its satisfaction. Value is created through anticipating and managing guests' expectations and showing the capacity and responsibility to meet their demands. The hospitality industry has been experiencing hard rivalry throughout the years and is expected to be much more complex in the coming years (Anwar & Abdullah, 2021). In a competitive market, a high value and a tool for enhancing service quality are crucial; guests want their hotel experience to meet or exceed their expectations, and nearly all hotels can achieve customer satisfaction by giving excellent service (Top & Ali, 2021). Satisfied guests will then be able to create strong memories and direct guests to become loyal.

When evaluating services, today's guests are more concerned about quality than money. This means that the hotels need to create and exhibit a standard of excellence that fits the demands of their guests. (Othman et al., 2019). The hotel exists because they have guests to serve (Valdani, 2009). Nowadays, the guests in the hospitality industry have become more sophisticated and more required (Abdullah & Othman, 2019). It is essential for hotels to know their guests' perceptions of their services to ensure that they are in accordance with their expectations, which is the

foundation of recognizing visitors' location, for instance, where they came from and what they expect (Khan & Abdullah, 2019). The hotel's level of customer service is the most important consideration in the hospitality sector. To ensure customer happiness, an effective service quality strategy must be implemented (Othman et al., 2019).

Guiuan, Eastern Samar, is one of the tourism destinations in Region VIII, blessed with plenteous wonders to offer. Other than the natural attractions such as white sand beaches, beautiful lakes, magnificent caves, rich diving sites, and world-class surfing spots, it has also served as a venue for significant events in Philippine history. First, it was in Homonhon Island that explorer Ferdinand first set foot on Philippine soil in 1521, thus discovering the Philippines by the Westerners. Second, in 1944, the American forces landed on the island of Suluan, where they fought their first battle in the Philippine territory. Third, the town is also the home of the 16th -century church of Immaculate Conception. Thus, tourists can enjoy several activities such as visiting historical landmarks and witnessing cultural presentations such as festivals and trade fairs. Also, the province is a good place for hiking, caving, rock climbing, spelunking, surfing, scuba diving, kayaking, sightseeing, swimming, and other exciting activities.

Despite the different wonders and the existence of the

tourism and hospitality industry in the municipality, there is no existing study on the quality of the hospitality services of the various existing hotels. Thus, it gives the desire for the researchers to explore beyond these aspects as they believe it is one of the essential components to enhance the delivery of service of the hotel industry in Guiuan, Eastern Samar to attract more guests in the years to come.

Moreover, several literatures merely explored the service quality, customer satisfaction, loyalty, and predictors of customer satisfaction but fewer studies on determining the perception and expectation of guests on the services of the hotels considering the gap analysis in determining guest satisfaction.

Research Questions

This study aims to assess guest perception and expectations towards hospitality services of accommodation establishments in Guiuan E. Samar to better serve them by addressing their most immediate needs.

Specifically, answers the following questions:

1. What is the level of guest expectations and perception towards the hospitality services of hotels in terms of:
 - 1.1 tangibility
 - 1.2 responsiveness
 - 1.3 reliability
 - 1.4 assurance; and
 - 1.5 empathy?
2. What is the discrepancy gap between guest expectation and perception towards the hospitality services of accommodation establishments in Guiuan E. Samar?
3. Is there a significant mean difference between guest perceptions and expectations?
4. What is the overall level of guests' satisfaction with the hospitality service quality?

Literature Review

Managers in the hotel sector need to focus on keeping their existing clients happy and loyal by developing customer satisfaction and loyalty policies at work. Customer satisfaction is directly tied to the quality of the service provided. Kotler et al., (2013), defined customer satisfaction as a feeling of pleasure or disappointment when comparing a product's perceived performance or outcome to expectations. The customer is satisfied if it exceeds the expectation. Further, the

key to long-term marketing success is building client loyalty, which is at the core of any organization. As noted by Tahir, Waggett, and Hoffman (2013), customer satisfaction is based on customer perspective and their expectation and then subsequent post-purchase experience. In other words, it is an evaluation of a product or service quality level to assess whether it exceeds or fails to meet the customer's expectation. The Expectancy Disconfirmation Theory consists of four components: expectations, perceived performance, disconfirmation, and satisfaction. Expectations define the customer's anticipations about performance of products and services (McKinney, Yoon and Zahedi, 2002). Disconfirmation is defined as the difference between the customer's initial expectation and observed actual performance (Bhattacharjee & Premkumar, 2004). This theory, satisfaction is determined by the discrepancy between perceived performance and cognitive standards such as expectation and desires. Service quality is consisted of Tangibility, Responsiveness, Reliability, Assurance, and Empathy.

Tangibility is a visible aspect of the service employed by businesses to improve external customer satisfaction. It includes the physical facilities, equipment, and personnel's appearance (Panda and Das, 2014). Moreover, tangibility was one of the dimensions that were highly ranked that contributes to guests' satisfaction. Boshoff and Gray (2004) in their study of investigating the relationship between service quality and customer satisfaction and loyalty, concluded that cleanliness, neatness of the buildings' décor, and appearance of the staff impacted guests' loyalty. However, a different finding was conferred of Sohail (2003) that expectations regarding modern equipment, visual appearance of facilities, and professional appearance were relatively low. In addition, De Jager and Du Plooy (2007) stated that satisfaction was found to be best for clear signage and communication at an intelligible level in the tangibility of information stated that the level of satisfaction was the highest for clear information signages and communication at an understandable level which was supported by the findings of Tuan and Hai (2014) that tangibility has a highest impact to guests' satisfaction.

According to Tessera et al. (2016), responsiveness is important because visitors place a high value on hotel staff being able to provide rapid assistance, meet guests' requests, provide speedy check-in and check-out services, repair problems swiftly, and pay close attention to their guests. This shows that customer satisfaction is directly linked to the ability of staff to respond quickly and effectively to any issues that may

arise during a customer's stay. Furthermore, customers are more likely to keep a formal connection with a company if they are happy with the contact employees—additionally, apologizing, being courteous, and being prompt for handling positively influenced customer satisfaction (Liao & Chuang, 2007).

In the context of service quality, reliability may be defined as the process through which a service provider remains faithful in providing services to its clients. (Khan & Fasih, 2014, after, Blery, et al., 2009). Ibáñez, Hartmann & Calvo's (2006) The reliability of service, service quality, performance, and customer satisfaction are positively correlated to guest satisfaction. Customer and staff interactions are what make this feasible. This facet of service quality is made possible by focusing on people (Kaura et al., 2012). Hotels must perform the promised service dependably and accurately, where they should do things right and put great honor to all commitments (Yator, 2012; Sriyam, 2010). In the study of Kumar & Samtani (2021) they concluded that reliability has the highest significant effect on guests' satisfaction and loyalty. Same findings with that of Johnson and Karlay (2018) when they measure service and customer satisfaction. It was revealed that out of the five dimensions of service quality, reliability has the highest significant level. Therefore, hotels have to take action to improve their service concerning reliability; they have to provide what their guests expect from the time they arrive in the hotel premises until they go back to their place of origin.

Assurance refers to the degree to which service workers instill confidence and credibility in the firm's clients (Kandampully, 2007). It is the "workers' expertise and civility, and the service provider's ability to instill trust and confidence" that are most important factors (Zeithaml et al., 2006). Wei (2019) concluded that assurance of service quality is significant for every hotel business. The hotel should ensure all its service providers are courteous and able to deliver precise and accurate services to their potential guests. The assurance will often be importantly defined by guests (Marić et al., 2016). In addition, Of et al. (2020) found that hotel and resort personnel' expertise and kindness were valued by clients since they helped them build trust and confidence in the hotels. In addition, consumers have agreed that hotel staff' commitment to offering excellent services, expertly addressing disagreements, and efficient service delivery resulted in happy customers for long-term gains. On the contrary, a favorable but minor influence on consumer loyalty was reported by Meshack and Prusty (2021),

indicating that confidence was not a critical factor. Findings show that when customers are satisfied with their hotel's service, they create a strong sense of loyalty to the hotel and promote a link between responsiveness, empathy, certainty, and allegiance to the hotel.

Empathy is the supply of individual attention and a simple operating time; it is the provision of personal attention and an awareness of the guests' unique demands (Ananth et al., 2011). Empathy does not show an impact on customer satisfaction and retention (Meshack & Prusty 2021; Sanjaya et al. 2020; Ibrahim 2015). In contrast, empathy must be maximized as one of the alternative techniques and as a screening study for visitors' contentment with their overnight stay. (Johnson & Karlay, 2018; Tessera et al., 2016). Additionally, research indicates that service quality traits, such as empathy, have a positive correlation with customer satisfaction (Lee et al., 2018; Liat et al., 2014; Amin et al., 2013). Previous researchers have also stated similar claims on this dimension in various contexts, including tourism. It's also important to have a firm grasp of the underlying assumptions and shared interests that underlie all service-related activities and services. Services will operate more smoothly and be of higher quality if all parties involved in providing the service have the same level of empathy and dedication to providing high-quality service (Parasuraman, 2001). In their study, Iglesias & Guillén (2004) reported the close connection empathy has with customer satisfaction, and other researchers like Al-Marri et al. (2007) assert the same relation. This aspect made consumers pleased and functioned as an important predictor of future growth in the hotel's financial success. Because of this, the hotel's guests are more likely to return and suggest it to their friends and family because of its staff's caring attitude. (Wieseke et al., 2012). According to Parasuraman (2001), one element impacting visitors' dissatisfaction with services is a lack of personnel capable of providing requested information; staff have been unable to address passenger complaints and have not offered prompt service. Then, it is necessary to give a clear and wise understanding of various alternatives ease to follow the proper service requirements. In addition, when complaints are handled well, they may be turned into opportunities for the hotel to improve its service to the customer.

Hotels must meet what the guests expect as to the study of Shah et al. (2018), service attributes have a significant optimistic effect on customer satisfaction. Customer satisfaction was rated as the most important criterion in the research. Customers who have had a

pleasant experience are more likely to return to the location and to suggest it to others. In the hotel sector, a great client experience promotes customer satisfaction, which lowers the number of complaints. Additionally, clients will not perceive a great experience unless they believe the service is superior and more significant than the money they paid for. In summary, the results showed a negative gap between guests' expectations and perceptions.

Methodology

The study's primary purpose was to assess guests' satisfaction considering the gap between guest perception and expectations. This study utilized the descriptive-correlation research design; hence, the study aimed to determine if there is a significant difference between means of guest perception and expectation. According to Creswell (2012), the quantitative descriptive-correlation technique is appropriate when researchers wish to identify a study topic based on field trends or the need to explain why something occurs.

Participants

The study's respondents were the guests accommodated by Hotel A, B, C, D, and E. The researchers employed the convenience sampling technique to determine the number of samples. Convenience sampling (alternatively referred to as Haphazard Sampling or Accidental Sampling) is a type of nonprobability or nonrandom sampling in which members of the target population who meet certain practical criteria, such as ease of access, geographical proximity, availability at a specific time, or willingness to participate, are included in the study (Etikan, et. al, 2016). There was a total of 150 respondents participated in the study.

Instruments of the Study

The researchers used one set of survey instruments adopted from the study of Gunarathne (2014). It has 25 items divided into the different dimensions of tangibility, reliability, responsiveness, assurance, and empathy. The respondents were asked about their expectations and perceptions of the hospitality services of the hotels in Guiuan, Eastern Samar. The researchers administered the instrument validity and reliability test before its administration. Both tangibility and reliability have composite reliability of 0.86, responsiveness and assurance are 0.88, and empathy is 0.79. All of the alpha value of the 4 Likert

scale questionnaire has an overall total above 0.5 which according to Field (2013) is an acceptable alpha for statistical research, which was further supported by Taber (2018) from Cronbach's Alpha score of >0.80-1.00 is interpreted as very reliable/very good, >0.60-0.80 is reliable/good, >0.40-0.60 is quite reliable/good, >0.20-0.40 is rather reliable/not good, and 0.0-0.20 is less reliable/very poor.

Procedures

Permission to conduct the study was secured from the hotel owners. Upon giving the permission, the respondents were requested to answer the questionnaire personally handed to each of them by the researchers with the help of the hotel staff to ensure a 100% retrieval of the instrument. They were given at least twenty (20) minutes to answer the questionnaire. The researchers explained the directions of filling up the questionnaire thoroughly. Upon retrieving the completed questionnaires, the data were tallied, computer-processed, and interpreted using mean, and standard deviation to measure guests' satisfaction in terms of their perception and expectation of the hospitality services considering the tangibility, reliability, responsiveness, assurance, and empathy. While, the gap analysis was used in comparing means between expectation score and perception score of the respondents, and the data was analyzed using the SPSS program (Statistical Software Package). Also, the mean and gap difference were used to determine the guests' overall satisfaction. The Paired T-test was employed to determining the significant difference between the means.

Ethical Considerations

The study addressed ethical issues by establishing various measures instigating the use of introductory letters that sought the respondents' consent and voluntary participation. The research study also treated the respondents with respect and courtesy.

Result

This section presents the study's significant findings; it starts from the perception and expectation of the guests on the service quality of the hotels, followed by the discrepancy gap, the significant mean difference between guests' perception and expectation, and the overall guests' satisfaction.

Level of Guests' Perceptions and Expectations of Hospitality Services

This part is composed of the level of guests' perception and expectation towards hospitality services considering tangibility, responsiveness, reliability, assurance, and empathy.

Table 1.0

Level of Guests' Perception and Expectation of Hospitality Services in terms of Tangibility

Dimensions	Guests' Expectation			Guests' Perception		
	Mean	SD	Level	Mean	SD	Level
Furniture in the hotel is modern and comfortable.	3.57	0.55	High	3.17	0.61	Moderate
The interior and exterior decoration in the hotel is quite appealing.	3.53	0.59	High	3.31	0.65	High
The employees are properly dressed and neat.	3.52	0.58	High	3.30	0.67	High
The hotel facilities are up-to-date.	3.42	0.63	High	3.18	0.62	Moderate
The brochures and pamphlets are visually presented.	3.35	0.69	High	3.11	0.78	Moderate
The hotel is clean.	3.51	0.64	High	3.20	0.71	Moderate
Overall Mean	3.48	0.61	High	3.21	0.67	Moderate

It is shown in the table that the overall guests' expectation is at a high level ($M=3.48$). The item "Furniture in the hotel is modern and comfortable" got the highest score ($M=3.57$), followed by "The interior and exterior decoration in the hotel is quite appealing" ($M=3.53$). While the items "The employees are properly dressed and neat" and "The hotel is clean" got the third and fourth spot ($M=3.52$); ($M=3.51$) respectively. "The hotel facilities are up-to-date" is on the fifth spot ($M=3.42$). However, the item "The brochures and pamphlets are visually presented" got the lowest score ($M=3.35$). All of the items and the overall standard deviation are below 1.0, which shows homogeneity of the responses.

On the other hand, overall guests' perception is moderate ($M=3.21$). The first spot goes to the item "The interior and exterior decoration in the hotel is quite appealing" ($M=3.31$), seconded by the item "The employees are properly dressed and neat" ($M=3.30$). While item "The hotel is neat" has a score of ($M=3.20$) which is third on the list, followed by the item "Furniture in the hotel is modern and comfortable" ($M=3.17$). Same with guest expectation, the item "The brochures and pamphlets are visually presented" got the lowest perception ($M=3.11$), which is interpreted as "Moderate" in the qualitative description.

Table 1.1

Level of Guests' Perceptions and Expectations of Hospitality Services in terms of Responsiveness

Dimensions	Guests' Expectation			Guests' Perception		
	Mean	SD	Level	Mean	SD	Level
The employees are courteous.	3.57	0.55	High	3.30	0.60	High
The employees gave us special attention	3.49	0.59	High	3.30	0.60	High
The employees adopted services to our needs.	3.42	0.62	High	3.29	0.68	High
The staff are willing to help guests.	3.51	0.61	High	3.27	0.69	High
The staff tell you exactly when services will be provided.	3.55	0.61	High	3.21	0.74	Moderate
The staff give you prompt service.	3.46	0.61	High	3.17	0.70	Moderate
Overall Mean	3.50	0.60	High	3.26	0.80	High

Generally, as shown in table 1.1, the guests have a high level of expectation of quality service in terms of responsiveness ($M=3.50$). Among the different dimensions, guests have a high expectation to the courtesy of the employees ($M=3.57$), followed by the dimension "The staff tell you exactly when services will be provided" ($M=3.55$), covering the third spot is the item "The staff are willing to help guests" ($M=3.51$), fourth in line is the item "The employees gave us special attention" ($M=3.49$), followed by the item "The staff give you a prompt service" ($M=3.46$). Lastly, the item "The employees adopted services to our needs" ($M=3.42$).

By looking to how the guests perceived the responsiveness factor as quality service, four of the items got the high level of perception, and two for moderate. However, the overall level of perception of the guests is high ($M=3.26$) same with guests' expectations. The item "The employees are courteous" got a high level of perception ($M=3.30$). Similarly, the item "The employees gave us special attention" obtain the same rating ($M=3.30$), followed by the item "The employees adopted services to our need" ($M=3.29$). Considering the willingness of the staff to help guests, it gains a rating of ($M=3.27$), earning the fourth spot; meanwhile, the item "The staff tells you exactly when services will be provided" place it to the fifth spot ($M=3.21$) while item "The staff give you prompt service" got the lowest rating ($M=3.17$). All items have a standard deviation of less than 1.0, which direct a homogeneity of the responses.

Table 1.2

*Level of Guests' Perceptions and Expectations of**Hospitality Services in terms of Reliability*

Dimensions	Guests' Expectation			Guests' Perception		
	Mean	SD	Level	Mean	SD	Level
The front desk employee accurately verified the reservation requests.	3.55	0.55	High	3.12	0.60	Moderate
The time it took to check in or check out is not too long.	3.49	0.54	High	3.21	0.68	Moderate
The reservation system is easy to use (telephone and internet reservation).	3.39	0.61	High	3.08	0.79	Moderate
Transport facilities are available.	3.31	0.67	High	3.05	0.74	Moderate
The employees provide error-free records.	3.35	0.67	High	3.05	0.62	Moderate
The staff offer you some help (for example, once arrive at the front desk of the hotel, the receptionist ask you if she can help you).	3.43	0.62	High	3.11	0.79	Moderate
Overall Mean	3.42	0.61	High	3.10	0.70	Moderate

As reflected in table 1.2, guests have a high level of expectation of all the dimensions of reliability ($M=3.42$). They mainly expect that the front desk employee accurately verified their reservation requests as reflected on the result. Moreover, on checking in and checking out, which they wish not to be long, the staff will provide some help when they need it. Less expectation from the guests on the availability of transport facilities ($M=3.31$).

Meanwhile, the perception of guests on the hospitality services of the hotels is moderately high ($M=3.10$). As shown in the table, all of the dimensions under the reliability factor of service quality are perceived as moderately high. The item "The time it took to check in or check out is not too long" is moderately high as perceived by the guests. It is seconded by the item "The front desk employee accurately verified the reservation requests," ($M=3.12$), which also followed by the item "The staff offers you some help (for example, once you arrive at the front desk of the hotel, the receptionist ask you if she can help you) ($M=3.11$). Second to the last item is "The reservation system is easy to use (telephone and internet reservation) ($M=3.08$). The lowest mean rating was obtained by the items "Transportation facilities are available" and "The employees provide error-free records" with both ($M=3.05$) scores. All of the items have a standard deviation less than 1.0, which indicates homogeneity of the responses.

Table 1.3

*Level of Guests' Perceptions and Expectations of**Hospitality Services in terms of Assurance*

Dimensions	Guests' Expectation			Guests' Perception		
	Mean	SD	Level	Mean	SD	Level
The staff makes all guests feel safe when staying at the hotel (for example, the doorman observes the persons who come in the hotel).	3.55	0.56	High	3.25	0.66	Moderate
The staff have product knowledge of hotel information e.g. describing all room types and the restaurants.	3.52	0.56	High	3.25	0.67	Moderate
The staff speaks by using an appropriately address forms (for example, hello, may I help you, Sir/Madam).	3.56	0.62	High	3.39	0.67	High
The staff are trustworthy	3.53	0.58	High	3.27	0.62	High
Overall Mean	3.57	0.57	High	3.28	0.64	High

Guests' expectation of assurance is very high ($M=3.56$), as reflected in table 1.3. Among the dimension, they have a high expectation of the friendliness of the staff, followed by the provision of acceptable solutions to their problems; then the way staff speaks to them using an appropriate address for; however, staff product knowledge of hotel information obtain the lowest score ($M=3.52$), having a standard deviation of 0.56 which imply a homogeneity of the responses. It is indicated in the result the need for the hotel staff to be friendly to their guests by way of appropriately addressing them using appropriate words and providing an acceptable solution to their problems regarding with their stay in the hotel.

On the other hand, only three from the six dimensions obtain the highest level of perception from the guests; they are the items "The staff speaks by using an appropriately address form (for example, hello, may I help you, Sir/Madam)", "The staff are friendly", and "The staff are trustworthy" having a mean score of ($M=3.39$), ($M=3.35$), and ($M=3.27$) respectively. Meanwhile, the item "The hotel always provides acceptable solutions to guests' problems" got the lowest mean ($M= 3.16$), which conversely differs from that of the guests' expectations.

Table 1.4

Level of Guests' Perceptions and Expectations of Hospitality Services in terms of Empathy

Dimensions	Guests' Expectation			Guests' Perception		
	Mean	SD	Level	Mean	SD	Level
The employee quickly apologizes when service mistakes are made.	3.57	0.54	High	3.29	0.67	High
Employees understand guests' requirements.	3.54	0.62	High	3.18	0.66	Moderate
Hotel employees show interest in serving their guests by heart.	3.49	0.60	High	3.25	0.67	Moderate
Employees of the hotel makes guests feel warm and welcome	3.61	0.52	High	3.29	0.66	High
Employees of the hotel makes guests feel warm and welcome	3.61	0.52	High	3.29	0.66	High
Hotel employees show genuine care and concern when giving guests personal attention.	3.53	0.66	High	3.34	0.63	High
The hotel has operating hours that is convenient to customer requirements.	3.54	0.60	High	3.27	0.65	High
Overall Mean	3.55	0.59	High	3.27	0.66	High

It is reflected in table 1.4 that the overall level of guests' expectation is high ($M=3.55$) with a standard deviation lesser than 1.0. All of the dimension under empathy is rated as high expectation. But the item "Employees of the hotel makes guests feel warm and welcome" made it to the first spot ($M=3.61$), followed by the item "The employee quickly apologizes when service mistakes are made" ($M=3.57$). While the items "Employees understand guests' requirements" and "The hotel has operating hours that are convenient to customer requirement" are on the third spot ($M=3.54$) followed by the item "Employees understand guests' requirements" ($M=3.49$). Lastly, is the item "Hotel employees show interest in serving their guests by heart," ($M=3.34$).

The overall perception of the guests to the empathy factor of the hotel service quality in its hospitality services has a high level ($M=3.27$) having less than 1.0 standard deviation, which represents a homogeneity of the responses. Among the six dimensions, the highest mean rating earner, which is also perceived as high, is the "Hotel employees show genuine care and concern when giving guests personal attention" ($M=3.34$), followed by the items "The employee quickly apologizes when service mistakes are made" and "Employees of the hotels makes guests feel warm and welcome" ($M=3.29$). Next, the item "The hotel has operating hours that are convenient to customer requirements" ($M=3.27$). While the item "Hotel employees show interest in serving guests by heart" ($M=3.25$), is interpreted as "Moderate" in the qualitative description earning the second to the last in line. Likewise, a "Moderate" interpretation is given to the item "Employees understand guests' requirements," ($M=3.18$) taken with the lowest mean rating.

Discrepancy Gap Between Guests Expectations and Perceptions

The second problem that researchers wanted to determine if the discrepancy gap between guests' expectations and perceptions from the different service quality dimensions. The gap is calculated between the mean score of perception and expectation. The findings of the study showed the difference between expectation and perception as shown in the table below.

Table 2.0.

Discrepancy Gap Between Guests' Expectations and Perceptions

Attributes	Guests' Expectation	Guests' Perception	SERVQUAL Gap
Tangibility	3.21	3.48	0.27
Responsiveness	3.50	3.26	-0.24
Reliability	3.42	3.10	-0.32
Assurance	3.56	3.28	-0.28
Empathy	3.27	3.55	0.28
Overall Mean	3.39	3.33	-0.06

Table 2.0 provide us with the gap between guests' expectation and guests' perception towards hospitality services of hotels. As shown in the table, guests' expectations are higher ($M=3.39$) than guests' perception ($M=3.33$), indicating that guests' expectations are not met by the hotels in some of the attributes. The negative gap indicates that the guests are not satisfied with the hotels' services. Reliability having the highest negative gap of -0.32, is the most crucial attribute that hotels need to answer, considering the accuracy of reservations, transportation facilities, error-free service, and the willingness of the employees to extend help in cases needed by the guests.

Mean Difference between Guests Expectations and Perceptions

The third problem that the researchers aim to answer is to determine if there is a significant mean difference between guests' expectations and perception of the hotels' hospitality services. The result will be used in defining guests' overall satisfaction with the hospitality services of the hotels along with the SERVQUAL gap. The table will show the mean difference between guests' expectations and perceptions using a paired t-test as an appropriate statistical treatment.

Table 3.0
Mean Difference Between Guests' Expectations and Perceptions

Attributes	MD	SD	95%		t	df	p-value
			LL	UL			
Pair 1. Tangibility	.27	.44	-0.34	-0.20	-7.58	149	.000
Pair 2. Responsiveness	-.24	.48	-0.39	-0.24	-8.00	149	.000
Pair 3. Reliability	-.32	.40	-0.31	-0.18	-7.53	149	.000
Pair 4. Assurance	-.28	.44	-0.35	-0.21	-7.92	149	.000
Pair 5. Empathy	.28	.43	-0.34	-0.20	-7.76	149	.000

Note: N=150, df =149, CI =Confidence Interval, LL = Lower limit, UL = Upper limit, $p < 0.05$

Table 3.0 is the outcomes of Paired samples t-test used to measure the expectation and perception of the guests to the service quality of the hotels towards their hospitality services. The computed mean difference between perception and expectation for tangibility is .27, indicating satisfaction, showing a significant variation in perception and expectation of service quality in tangibility ($t = -7.58$; $p = 0.000$). Therefore, there is a significant difference between the mean of guests' perception and expectation. Concerning responsiveness, the result shows a negative mean difference of -.24, which indicates dissatisfaction. It also shows substantial evidence of having a mean difference between the mean of guests' expectations and perception ($t = -8.00$; $p = 0.000$). The mean difference is also negative with the attribute reliability, indicating dissatisfaction, having ($t = -7.53$; $p = 0.000$) expresses a significant difference between the mean score of guests' perception and expectation in terms of quality service in reliability. The attribute assurance also has a mean difference of -.28, indicating dissatisfaction from the guests in terms of service quality, significantly provide a variation of expectation and perception of the guests ($t = -7.92$; $p = 0.000$). Therefore, there is a significant difference between the mean of guests' expectations and perception. Meanwhile, the attribute empathy also shows a negative mean difference of -.28, and significantly differ between the mean score of guests' expectations and perception ($t = -7.76$; $p = 0.000$). Generally, guests' expectations and perception of the service quality of the hotels in its hospitality services considering tangibility, responsiveness, reliability, assurance, and empathy has a significant difference.

Overall Guests' Satisfaction with Hospitality Services

The fourth question that the researchers wanted to find out is the guests' overall satisfaction with the hospitality services of hotels. The table below presents the general guests' satisfaction with the hospitality

services of the hotel using the gap analysis.

Table 4.0
Guests' overall Satisfaction with Hospitality Services

Attributes	Mean		Gap	p-value	Interpretation	Rank
	Guests' Expectation	Guests' Perception				
Tangibility	3.21	3.48	0.27	.000	Satisfied	4
Responsiveness	3.50	3.26	-0.24	.000	Not Satisfied	5
Reliability	3.42	3.10	-0.32	.000	Not Satisfied	1
Assurance	3.56	3.28	-0.28	.000	Not Satisfied	2
Empathy	3.27	3.55	0.28	.000	Satisfied	2
Overall Mean	3.39	3.33	-0.06		Not Satisfied	

In table 4.0, the overall satisfaction of guests to hospitality services of hotels is being shown. The attributes responsiveness, reliability, and assurance got the negative gap, which tells us that those guests are not satisfied with the hospitality services in terms of those attributes, having an overall mean difference of -0.06 and p-values of lesser than 0.05. Hotels must emphasize the attributes reliability as it has the highest negative gap of -0.32, followed by assurance having a negative gap of -0.28. However, less attention on responsiveness having the lowest service quality gap of -0.24.

Discussion

The study aimed to assess guest perception and expectation towards hospitality services of hotels in Guiuan Eastern Samar to better serve them by addressing their most immediate needs. There is a high expectation of the guests regarding hospitality services in its tangibility, especially on adapting to modern interior and exterior design that are appealing. In addition, cleanliness and up-to-date hotel facilities are likewise expected. In like manner, it is highly perceived that the interior and exterior of the hotel facilities are pleasing and employees are properly dressed and neat. Nevertheless, there is a need to provide pamphlets and brochures that are something to be used as a reference while they are accommodated in the hotel. Also, a high expectation to the reliability factor of the hospitality service of the hotels. However, it is moderately perceived by the guests. They expect that the front desk employee accurately verified their reservation. Also, on checking in and checking out, which they wish not to be long, and the staff will be providing some help when they need it. Less expectations on the availability of transport facilities. All of the dimensions under the reliability factor of service quality are perceived as moderately high. Generally, the guests have a high level of expectation on responsiveness. Among the different dimension,

they have a high expectation to the courtesy of the employees. The four dimensions have been highly perceived, and two for moderate. Same with expectations, there is also a high level of perception. Regarding assurance, guests' have a high expectation of the friendliness of the staff, followed by the provision of acceptable solutions to their problems; then the way staff speaks to them using an appropriate address. On the other hand, only three from the six dimensions obtain the highest level of perception from the guests, which conversely differs from that of the guests' expectations. The overall level of guests' expectation for empathy is high and all of the dimension was rated as high.

Guests' expectation is higher than their perception, indicating that their expectations are not met by the hotels in some of the service quality attributes. Responsiveness having the highest negative gap is the most attribute that needs to be answered by hotels, considering employees' courtesy, adopting services relating to the needs of the guests, the willingness of the employees to assist and provide prompt and exact service, as well as special attention. Generally, guests are not satisfied with the hospitality services in terms of responsiveness, reliability, and assurance. Moreover, guests' expectations and perception of the service quality of the hotels in its hospitality services considering tangibility, responsiveness, reliability, assurance, and empathy has a significant difference.

Conclusion

Several literatures discuss how important service quality in hospitality industry in providing satisfaction to guests. Tangibility, Responsiveness, Reliability, Assurance, and Empathy are the common attributes in measuring quality services. Guests have a high expectation of the hotel's interior, exterior, cleanliness, and up-to-date facilities. Also, on verifying their reservations and the time they wait in checking in and checking out, and how the staff assists in cases, they need some help. The friendliness of the hotel employees and their courtesy to the guests and the feeling of warm welcome is also expected by the guests. However, the guests are not satisfied with the attributes responsiveness, reliability, assurance, and empathy. Therefore, hotels must take full responsibility to put serious efforts to enhance the employees' skills, new training methods implementation to increase the caring and concerning attitude towards guests to satisfy them. Additionally, hotels must keep momentum by delivering assured services as promised in order to provide at their best

and improve some current situations, such as a lack of attention paid to customer inquiries or complaints, a lack of time spent paying particular attention, and so forth. Hotels service quality is often poor, since clients are dissatisfied with all aspects of their stay. There is more that can be done to exceed customer satisfaction across all service quality dimensions, including reliability, responsiveness, and assurance. Hotels must invest those aspects of the service quality attributes to cater to a better service. It should start from conducting an internal situational analysis to determine where they begin and end. Moreover, comparative study might be conducted regarding guests' satisfaction with hospitality services of the country's four-to-five-star hotels. Also, guests' cultural backgrounds and levels of satisfaction as it may differ between their expectations and perceptions regarding hospitality services. Other factors on guests' satisfaction may also be considered.

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